

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Cooks and Kitchen Staff English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Line cooks, prep cooks, kitchen assistants, and dish-team colleagues.

All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Clarifying a prep list

Clarify quantities before interpreting a kitchen shorthand.

02 Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

Distinguish a physical count from an expected quantity.

03 Reading tickets and modifications

Read back ticket identity, revised quantity, and the exact change.

04 Coordinating the pass

Separate individual dish progress from readiness of the full order.

05 Communicating a shortage and an alternative

Explain a shortage and obtain the missing choice.

06 Checking dietary modifications

Challenge an overbroad conclusion using the stated dietary concern.

07 Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

Request a named response to an observed equipment problem.

08 Closing and handing over unfinished work

Transfer closing work without making incomplete checks disappear.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying a prep list

Clarify quantities before interpreting a kitchen shorthand.

SITUATION

The prep list says 'soup: 24' without a unit. Yesterday's sheet used portions; the storeroom label uses containers. The lead intended 24 portions from the current recipe, not 24 containers. No batch has started.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

mise en place - Ingredients and equipment organized for a kitchen's planned work.

prep list - A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service.

yield - The usable amount a recipe or ingredient is expected to produce.

batch - A quantity of food prepared as one planned production unit.

Useful word combinations

check the required yield: confirm the usable amount needed

work from the prep list: use the current task list

prepare one batch: make the specified production quantity

clarify the unit: distinguish portions, containers, and weights

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask what the number counts

3. Notice the language

Numbers need units. A recipe's yield and a container count describe different things; familiarity with yesterday's sheet isn't confirmation for today.

Does ___ mean portions or ___?

Which recipe version applies to ___?

So the required yield is ___, not ___.

Compare this wording: I'll make twenty-four.

Clearer: Do you mean twenty-four portions from the current recipe?

The question attaches a unit and recipe to the number.

4. Check the language

1. Lead: Twenty-four means individual servings, not a weight or production grouping.

Cook: The required yield is twenty-four ____.

A. containers

B. kilograms

C. portions

D. batches

2. Cook: Could you confirm ____ applies today?

Lead: The version dated Monday.

A. which recipe does

B. which does recipe

C. which recipe

D. recipe which

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Twenty-four what?

The ambiguous soup prep line in the case.

01 • Prep cook: The soup line says twenty-four. Does that mean individual portions or filled storage containers?

02 • Lead cook: It means twenty-four portions today. We haven't specified a number of containers on this list.

03 • Prep cook: Thanks. Which recipe version should I use to check the required yield for that quantity?

04 • Lead cook: Use Monday's current recipe. The older sheet in the folder has a different yield.

05 • Prep cook: I'll work from Monday's version, then. Has anyone already started part of this batch?

06 • Lead cook: No, you're taking the whole soup assignment. The other cook is preparing salad components instead.

07 • Prep cook: So twenty-four portions is the total target, not twenty-four more than someone else's preparation?

08 • Lead cook: Correct. That's the total for your assignment, and nothing has been counted toward it yet.

09 • Prep cook: I'll mark the unit on my copy and repeat the target at the prep check.

10 • Lead cook: Good. Bring me any recipe discrepancy before assuming the older figures still apply today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A total, not an addition

A kitchen assistant clarifies a revised list during preparation.

01 • Assistant: The updated list says twelve trays. Are those twelve additional trays or the overall total?

02 • Cook: Twelve is the total needed. Four trays have already been counted as complete for this assignment.

03 • Assistant: Then eight remain, assuming those four belong to the same order on this updated sheet.

04 • Cook: They do. The completed trays carry the same order reference as the revised list.

05 • Assistant: I'll work toward eight more, rather than adding twelve to the four already finished.

06 • Cook: Exactly. Please don't count the separate display tray toward this order; it belongs elsewhere.

07 • Assistant: Thanks for pointing that out. Is the display tray included in any of these figures?

08 • Cook: No, it's listed on the counter-service sheet and isn't part of today's twelve-tray order.

09 • Assistant: I'll keep the two counts separate when I report the remaining work to the lead.

10 • Cook: That will help. Report eight outstanding on this order and leave the display count unchanged.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Prep ready for whom?

A cook checks what a colleague means by 'ready'.

01 • Cook: You said my mise en place was ready. Is the garnish at my station yet?

02 • Colleague: It's prepared on the prep bench, but I haven't transferred it to your station yet.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I was looking in the station supplies and thought we had run out.

04 • Colleague: We haven't run out. The completed garnish is assigned to your station on this list.

05 • Cook: Could you confirm the quantity? I need to report our remaining prep before service starts.

06 • Colleague: There are eighteen portions for your station, and another six belong to the lunch counter.

07 • Cook: I'll report eighteen prepared for us, with the transfer still outstanding at this moment.

08 • Colleague: Yes, and please keep the lunch-counter allocation separate so it doesn't get counted twice.

09 • Cook: Who's bringing it over? I can collect it once we've finished this handover.

10 • Colleague: Please take that task. I'll tell the lead it's assigned to you, not already complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying a prep list

The prep list says 'soup: 24' without a unit. Yesterday's sheet used portions; the storeroom label uses containers. The lead intended 24 portions from the current recipe, not 24 containers. No batch has started.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead cook: confirm 24 portions using Monday's recipe; container numbers are storage counts.

Second round: The cook finds a second sheet dated Friday. Identify which sheet governs today's task.

Scenario 2 | A handwritten abbreviation

A prep note reads '6 c.' The recipe uses cups, but the delivery list uses cases. The lead intended six cups for a practice recipe discussion; no preparation has begun.

Role A: Cook: ask what the abbreviation means.

Role B: Lead: expand it to cups and identify the recipe, not a delivery order.

Possible opening: Could you spell out the unit beside the six?

Success checks

- Identify the current document.
- Obtain the full unit.
- Repeat the quantity without using the ambiguous abbreviation.

Add a complication: A colleague says the same abbreviation meant cases yesterday.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

Distinguish a physical count from an expected quantity.

SITUATION

The delivery note lists six cases of tomatoes; four are physically present. The driver says two may be on another trolley but has not checked. The receiving lead must resolve the record. Report the observed count without accusing the supplier or recording six as received.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

delivery note - A supplier's document listing items and quantities sent with a delivery.

short delivery - A delivery containing less than the quantity expected.

traceability - The ability to connect a food item to its source and relevant identifying records.

lot code - A label identifier linking a product to a production batch or lot.

Useful word combinations

count the delivered cases: check the actual number received

flag a missing label: report absent identifying information

match the delivery note: compare physical items with the supplier's list

report a short delivery: state the difference between expected and received quantities

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Report what was actually counted

3. Notice the language

Use 'lists' for the document and 'counted' for the observation. A possible explanation is not a verified delivery.

The note lists ____; I counted ____.

We haven't established whether ____.

Could you reconcile ____ before ____?

Compare this wording: The supplier lost two cases.

Clearer: Four cases are here; the location of the other two is unconfirmed.

This reports the discrepancy without inventing a cause.

4. Check the language

1. Driver: Two might be on the other trolley, but I haven't checked.

Cook: Their location is still ____.

A. confirmed at this doorway

B. recorded at the first trolley

C. verified in the storeroom

D. unconfirmed

2. Lead: How many cases did you personally count?

Cook: I ____ four beside the delivery note.

A. forecast

B. ordered

C. requested

D. counted

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six on paper, four on the floor

The tomato delivery count in the case.

01 • Cook: The delivery note lists six tomato cases, but I counted four beside this trolley.

02 • Receiving lead: Did the driver say the remaining two are missing, or just somewhere else?

03 • Cook: They said two might be on another trolley. They haven't actually checked it yet.

04 • Receiving lead: Then we have four observed and two unconfirmed. Please show me the delivery note.

05 • Cook: Here it is. I haven't recorded all six as received because the count doesn't match.

06 • Receiving lead: Good. I'll ask the driver to reconcile the physical count before we complete the record.

07 • Cook: Should I describe this as a confirmed short delivery in the kitchen update now?

08 • Receiving lead: Say two cases are currently unaccounted for. We haven't established whether they arrived elsewhere.

09 • Cook: Understood. I'll report four here and the remaining two under review with you.

10 • Receiving lead: Thank you. That gives the kitchen a usable count without assigning a cause prematurely.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A label cannot be read

A kitchen assistant reports an unreadable product identifier.

01 • Assistant: This container's product label is readable, but the lot code underneath it is obscured.

02 • Lead cook: Can you connect it to the matching delivery record, or is that link unclear too?

03 • Assistant: The product name matches, but there are two deliveries with different codes on today's sheet.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't guess which code belongs to it. I'll ask the receiving team to check.

05 • Assistant: I'll leave its status unresolved and identify the exact container in my report to them.

06 • Lead cook: Please mention that the product name is visible; it's the lot code that needs clarification.

07 • Assistant: Would a photograph of the label help them identify which area is unreadable here?

08 • Lead cook: Use our normal reporting method and keep the original container available for their inspection.

09 • Assistant: I'll describe the obscured code and the two possible delivery records without choosing between them.

10 • Lead cook: We need the correct lot code for traceability. Don't copy one from another container.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Stock on hand versus available

A cook checks whether counted portions are already allocated.

01 • Cook: You counted twenty tart portions. Are all twenty available for tonight's dining room service?

02 • Prep colleague: No, six are allocated to the staff event. Fourteen remain available for the dining room.

03 • Cook: Thanks. The stock board just says twenty, so I nearly reported the whole count as available.

04 • Prep colleague: Let's distinguish the physical total from the allocation. Both numbers matter to the shift lead.

05 • Cook: I'll report twenty on hand, six reserved for the event, and fourteen for service.

06 • Prep colleague: That's right. The six aren't missing or already served; they're assigned to a different use.

07 • Cook: Has the event allocation changed since the last count, or is six still confirmed?

08 • Prep colleague: Six is confirmed on the event list. No one has requested a change to that number.

09 • Cook: I'll add that distinction to my spoken update so the server doesn't sell the reserved portions.

10 • Prep colleague: Please do. I'll check with the lead before any reserved portion is reassigned to service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

The delivery note lists six cases of tomatoes; four are physically present. The driver says two may be on another trolley but has not checked. The receiving lead must resolve the record. Report the observed count without accusing the supplier or recording six as received.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Driver: six are on the note; you haven't checked the second trolley yet.

Second round: The driver finds one more case. Update the observed count to five without declaring the delivery complete.

Scenario 2 | One box is a different product

A delivery note lists five cases of plain rolls. There are four plain-roll cases and one seeded-roll case. No substitution was agreed.

Role A: Cook: state counts and product names.

Role B: Receiving lead: review the mismatch with the supplier before accepting a substitution.

Possible opening: The fifth case has a different product description.

Success checks

- Count by product, not just container.
- Avoid declaring the substitute equivalent.
- Identify the unresolved substitution decision.

Add a complication: A colleague calls it 'five bread cases' and overlooks the product difference.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Reading tickets and modifications

Read back ticket identity, revised quantity, and the exact change.

SITUATION

Ticket 41 originally has two tarts. A new slip says 'three tarts, revised 41.' The expediter confirms this replaces the old quantity, so the total is three, not five. One tart has salad instead of potatoes. Confirm quantity and substitution.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

ticket - A kitchen's written or electronic record of a food order.

all day - Kitchen shorthand for the combined quantity currently ordered across the relevant open tickets.

on the fly - Kitchen shorthand requesting an item urgently; it does not remove required checks.

substitution - A replacement ingredient or item requested instead of the standard one.

Useful word combinations

call the full ticket number: identify the exact order aloud

read back the modification: repeat the requested change

count orders all day: total the relevant open orders

separate a correction from an addition: distinguish a changed order from an extra item

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Make corrections audible

3. Notice the language

A revised ticket may replace an earlier instruction. 'Instead of' signals replacement; 'as well as' signals addition.

Is this an addition or a correction to ___?

That's ___ total on ticket ___.

One with ___ instead of ___; the others ___.

Compare this wording: Three more tarts.

Clearer: Three total on revised ticket forty-one, not three additional tarts.

The distinction prevents duplicate production.

4. Check the language

1. Expediter: Replace the old two-tart count with three.

Cook: That's three ___.

A. each

B. total

C. extra

D. more

2. Expediter: One guest wants salad replacing potatoes.

Cook: One tart with salad ___ potatoes.

A. in addition to

B. along with

C. as well as

D. instead of

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three total, not five

Revised ticket 41 from the case.

01 • Cook: Revised forty-one says three tarts. Does that replace the original two or add another three?

02 • Expediter: It replaces the original quantity. The table needs three tarts total on that ticket.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I also see salad instead of potatoes, but the note doesn't identify a quantity.

04 • Expediter: That substitution belongs to one tart only. The other two keep their standard potatoes.

05 • Cook: So three tarts total: one with salad, two with potatoes. Is that the complete revision?

06 • Expediter: Yes. Don't combine the old ticket quantity with the new one when you count orders.

07 • Cook: I'll use the revised ticket and tell the other station the original quantity was replaced.

08 • Expediter: Please identify forty-one in that message; another table has a separate order for two tarts.

09 • Cook: Understood. The revision changes forty-one only and leaves the other table's order untouched.

10 • Expediter: Correct. Read back the table and ticket if another correction comes through during service.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

What does all day include?

A cook checks the scope of an order total.

01 • Cook: You called six soups all day. Does that include the two on the new takeaway ticket?

02 • Expediter: Yes, six includes those two. Four belong to dining-room tickets and two to takeaway.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I was about to add the takeaway pair again and report eight instead.

04 • Expediter: Keep the total at six. The separate packing instruction doesn't create two extra portions.

05 • Cook: Which ticket has the takeaway pair? I want the service format attached to the right order.

06 • Expediter: Ticket fifty-three. The other four portions are listed across the two dining-room tickets beside it.

07 • Cook: I'll repeat six total, with two assigned to takeaway ticket fifty-three and four for tables.

08 • Expediter: Exactly. Tell me if a cancellation arrives before treating that total as unchanged.

09 • Cook: No cancellation has reached me. I'll keep the current six unless you issue a revision.

10 • Expediter: Good. That gives both the quantity and the order split without counting anything twice.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Urgent is not specific

A cook clarifies an urgent verbal request.

01 • Expediter: I need a replacement tart on the fly for the table near the window.

02 • Cook: Which table number and ticket? There are three window tables in tonight's seating arrangement.

03 • Expediter: Table eighteen, ticket sixty. The original plate was the wrong dish and needs replacing.

04 • Cook: Thank you. Does the replacement keep the standard side, or is there a modification?

05 • Expediter: It needs salad instead of potatoes. That was on the original ticket for this diner.

06 • Cook: I'll read that back: replacement tart for eighteen, ticket sixty, salad instead of potatoes.

07 • Expediter: Correct. Please give me an estimate rather than assuming the urgency makes it immediately available.

08 • Cook: I'll check the station's current work and give you a realistic estimate for this replacement.

09 • Expediter: Thanks. I'll tell the server the request is accepted, with the estimate still pending.

10 • Cook: I'll call the ticket number with that estimate so it doesn't get attached elsewhere.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reading tickets and modifications

Ticket 41 originally has two tarts. A new slip says 'three tarts, revised 41.' The expeditor confirms this replaces the old quantity, so the total is three, not five. One tart has salad instead of potatoes. Confirm quantity and substitution.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Expediter: confirm three total, one salad substitution, and two standard accompaniments.

Second round: Someone calls 'three more' after the correction. Repair the quantity before work continues.

Scenario 2 | A canceled side remains on a screen

Ticket 72 originally includes two extra salads. The expeditor confirms one extra salad is canceled; the mains are unchanged.

Role A: Cook: clarify the remaining quantity.

Role B: Expediter: confirm one extra salad remains and both mains still stand.

Possible opening: Does this cancellation remove one salad or the whole ticket?

Success checks

- Keep both mains.
- State one extra salad remains.
- Repeat the ticket number when correcting the colleague.

Add a complication: A colleague heard only the word 'cancel'.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Coordinating the pass

Separate individual dish progress from readiness of the full order.

SITUATION

Ticket 28 has four mains. Two are plated; two are still at the cook's station. The cook estimates four more minutes for the remaining pair. The expeditor asks whether the whole table is ready. Report partial progress and the current estimate.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

pass - The kitchen area where completed dishes are checked and collected for service.

expediter - The person coordinating tickets, dish readiness, and pickups between kitchen and service staff.

pickup - The collection of dishes at the pass for delivery to a table or customer.

plating - Arranging the prepared components of a dish on its serving plate.

Useful word combinations

call a pickup: announce which completed order can be collected

synchronize the table: coordinate dishes intended to leave together

give a station update: state current progress on assigned dishes

keep the ticket visible: preserve the order reference during coordination

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

State partial readiness precisely

3. Notice the language

'Two are plated' doesn't mean 'four are ready.' Name the remaining items and the reference point for an estimate.

___ of ___ dishes are ___.

The remaining ___ need approximately ___.

Please wait for ___ before calling ___.

Compare this wording: Twenty-eight is basically done.

Clearer: Two of four mains are plated; the remaining pair needs about four minutes.

The update shows what prevents a full pickup.

4. Check the language

1. Expediter: Are all four mains plated?

Cook: Two are plated; the other two are ___.

A. fully served

B. both finished

C. still pending

D. already collected

2. Cook: My estimate is four minutes.

Expediter: I'll describe that as an ___ wait.

A. approximation

B. exactly

C. approximately

D. approximate

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Half a ticket is not a pickup

Ticket 28 from the case.

01 • Expediter: Can I call the pickup for twenty-eight? I see two plated mains at the pass.

02 • Cook: Not yet. There are four mains on that ticket, and two are still at my station.

03 • Expediter: How long do you estimate for the remaining pair, taking your current work into account?

04 • Cook: Approximately four more minutes. I'll tell you if that changes before the full ticket is ready.

05 • Expediter: I'll keep the pickup open, then. Are those two plated dishes definitely for twenty-eight?

06 • Cook: Yes, their ticket is beside them. They aren't part of the neighboring order for twenty-nine.

07 • Expediter: Good. The runner nearly combined them with that order because the plates looked similar.

08 • Cook: I'll keep the table reference clear and call you when the remaining pair reaches the pass.

09 • Expediter: Please do. I'll coordinate the full pickup after checking all four against the ticket.

10 • Cook: Understood. Two plated, two pending, with the current estimate still four more minutes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A garnish mismatch at the pass

An expeditor questions a visible difference between a dish and its ticket.

01 • Expediter: This ticket says no herb garnish, but the plate here has herbs on top.

02 • Cook: Let me check the ticket number before assuming that plate belongs to the modified order.

03 • Expediter: It's thirty-four, seat two. The dish beside it is the standard version for seat one.

04 • Cook: You're right. I've matched the standard plate to the wrong seat at the pass.

05 • Expediter: What is the next step for the modified dish? I haven't released either plate.

06 • Cook: I'll check the preparation status with the station lead and give you a confirmed correction.

07 • Expediter: Please keep the modification attached to seat two rather than changing both dishes on this ticket.

08 • Cook: Understood. One standard dish for seat one, one no-garnish order for seat two.

09 • Expediter: Tell me when the corrected pickup is ready for checking; don't just call the whole table done.

10 • Cook: I will name thirty-four and the two seat assignments when I return with the update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The runner needs the whole location

A cook repairs a vague pickup announcement.

01 • Runner: You called the back table, but there are several tables beyond the partition tonight.

02 • Cook: I meant table twenty-six. Let me give the full number rather than a location nickname.

03 • Runner: Thank you. Are all three dishes here for twenty-six, or does one belong elsewhere?

04 • Cook: Only the two marked plates are for twenty-six. The third belongs to table sixteen.

05 • Runner: Then I'll collect the two confirmed dishes and leave sixteen's plate beside its own ticket.

06 • Cook: Please check with the expeditor first; they're coordinating whether twenty-six's side dish joins this pickup.

07 • Runner: I hadn't seen a side dish on the runner copy. I'll ask about that before leaving.

08 • Cook: Good. My call identified the two mains, not whether the entire order was complete.

09 • Runner: The expeditor confirms the side is still pending and wants this pickup held for now.

10 • Cook: I'll keep the plates identified and let them make the next pickup call.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Coordinating the pass

Ticket 28 has four mains. Two are plated; two are still at the cook's station. The cook estimates four more minutes for the remaining pair. The expeditor asks whether the whole table is ready. Report partial progress and the current estimate.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Expediter: ask what is plated and whether the estimate covers the remaining pair.

Second round: The runner points to the two plated dishes and assumes the whole ticket can leave.

Scenario 2 | A takeaway order at the dining pass

Three containers for takeaway ticket 90 are ready, but the printed order lists four. The fourth is still at the dessert station.

Role A: Cook: report three ready and one pending.

Role B: Expediter: identify the missing dessert and obtain its estimate.

Possible opening: Is ticket ninety complete for collection?

Success checks

- Compare containers with the ticket.
- Name the missing component.
- Avoid declaring the whole order ready.

Add a complication: The courier asks whether seeing three containers means they can leave.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Communicating a shortage and an alternative

Explain a shortage and obtain the missing choice.

SITUATION

Three portions of potatoes remain unallocated, but a new ticket requests five. Rice is available as a proposed alternative side; the server must check whether two diners accept it. The cook cannot silently substitute. Agree who obtains the diners' decision.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

eighty-six - Kitchen slang indicating an item is unavailable; usage should be confirmed locally.

par level - A workplace's planned stock quantity used as a replenishment reference.

portion count - The number of servings currently counted for a particular item.

substitute item - An alternative dish or component offered in place of an unavailable one.

Useful word combinations

run low on a component: have little of a needed item remaining

update the available count: report the current usable allocation

offer an alternative side: propose a different accompaniment for approval

confirm guest acceptance: check that the diner agreed to the offered change

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Offer a named alternative with a condition

3. Notice the language

An available substitute is not an accepted substitute. Use 'if' to connect the offer to the diner's decision.

We have ___ left for ___ requested.

We can offer ___ if ___.

Please confirm which seats accept ___.

Compare this wording: I'll change two sides.

Clearer: Rice is available for two sides if those diners agree.

The choice stays with the diner instead of being silently imposed.

4. Check the language

1. Server: Have the guests accepted rice yet?

Cook: No; the rice is ____.

A. the original requested side

B. an accepted substitute

C. an available alternative

D. a completed change

2. Cook: If both guests ____ to rice, I can confirm the substitution.

Server: I'll ask them now.

A. agrees

B. agreeing

C. has agreed

D. agree

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three portions for five orders

The potato shortage in the case.

01 • Cook: The potato portion count is three, but this ticket asks for five sides.

02 • Server: Could you put rice on the other two plates and let me explain afterward?

03 • Cook: Please ask first. Rice is available, but we don't know which diners would accept it.

04 • Server: You're right. I'll offer rice to the table and get the actual seat choices.

05 • Cook: Thank you. Keep the three available potatoes separate from any portions already committed elsewhere.

06 • Server: Do you have enough rice for both proposed changes if two diners choose it?

07 • Cook: Yes, two rice sides are available for this proposal. Neither substitution is confirmed yet.

08 • Server: I'll return with the names of the two seats, or tell you if they decline.

09 • Cook: Then I'll read back the five sides against those seats before the ticket proceeds.

10 • Server: Agreed. I'll describe the shortage clearly rather than call rice the standard accompaniment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A stock word needs a scope

A cook clarifies whether a shortage concerns one dish or an ingredient.

01 • Cook: You called the mushrooms eighty-six. Do you mean the mushroom starter or every dish containing mushrooms?

02 • Expediter: The mushroom starter only. The pasta station has its own allocated ingredient stock for service.

03 • Cook: Thanks. I'll tell the servers the starter is unavailable, not remove the pasta from their options.

04 • Expediter: Please use the full dish name. The shortened call caused confusion at the other station too.

05 • Cook: Is the starter unavailable for the rest of this service, or just while another batch is checked?

06 • Expediter: The lead has marked it unavailable for tonight. No further starter batch is planned.

07 • Cook: I'll repeat that as mushroom starter unavailable tonight, with mushroom pasta availability unchanged.

08 • Expediter: Exactly. The separate allocation is why the dish name matters more than the ingredient nickname.

09 • Cook: I'll also check earlier starter orders before discussing replacements.

10 • Expediter: The lead is checking earlier tickets separately; the starter is unavailable for new orders tonight.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A par level is not an order

A prep cook questions a replenishment request.

01 • Prep cook: The par level says forty portions, but we have twenty and only ten orders expected.

02 • Lead cook: Are you asking whether to prepare twenty more just to reach the reference level?

03 • Prep cook: Yes. I don't want to treat the printed par figure as a new production instruction.

04 • Lead cook: That's sensible. Today's approved prep target stays at twenty because the service plan is smaller.

05 • Prep cook: Then the existing twenty meet today's target, even though they're below the usual par level.

06 • Lead cook: Correct. The par is a planning reference, not an automatic instruction for every shift.

07 • Prep cook: Should I tell the incoming cook why the board shows a difference from that reference?

08 • Lead cook: Please do. Explain the reduced target so they don't add an unnecessary batch later.

09 • Prep cook: I'll say twenty available against today's target of twenty, with the usual par unchanged at forty.

10 • Lead cook: Exactly. Any further production needs a new decision based on the service update, not the gap alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Communicating a shortage and an alternative

Three portions of potatoes remain unallocated, but a new ticket requests five. Rice is available as a proposed alternative side; the server must check whether two diners accept it. The cook cannot silently substitute. Agree who obtains the diners' decision.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Server: you can ask the five diners, but cannot choose two seats for them.

Second round: Only one diner accepts rice. Restate the remaining shortage and ask the lead about another option.

Scenario 2 | Only the garnish is unavailable

The herb garnish for a soup is unavailable. The soup itself remains available, but any presentation change needs the lead's decision and a server update.

Role A: Cook: identify the missing component, not the entire dish.

Role B: Lead: confirm whether a no-garnish presentation can be offered; no decision exists at the opening.

Possible opening: Are we marking the whole soup unavailable or just reporting the garnish shortage?

Success checks

- Separate component and dish.
- Obtain the lead's decision.
- Correct the server's earlier message accurately.

Add a complication: A colleague has already told one server 'no soup'.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Checking dietary modifications

Challenge an overbroad conclusion using the stated dietary concern.

SITUATION

Ticket 17 says 'no cheese.' The server then reports that the diner has a milk allergy. The sauce specification has not been checked. The cook must not treat omission of cheese as confirmation that the dish is suitable; the lead can review it with the server.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

recipe specification - The current documented ingredients and requirements for a particular dish.

allergen declaration - Information identifying allergens present in a product's ingredients.

cross-contact concern - A question about unintended allergen transfer during handling or preparation.

dietary modification - A requested change to a dish related to a diner's stated dietary need or choice.

Useful word combinations

check the specification: consult the current recipe information

refer the suitability question: ask the designated lead to assess the request

keep the order pending: leave the decision unresolved until the needed check occurs

distinguish omission from suitability: do not equate removing one component with resolving every dietary concern

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Name the missing check

3. Notice the language

A change to one ingredient doesn't establish the entire dish's suitability. Keep reported facts and the pending review explicit.

Omitting ___ does not establish ___.

The new information is ___.

We still need the lead to check ___.

Compare this wording: No cheese means the issue is settled.

Clearer: The cheese omission doesn't answer the milk-allergy question about the sauce.

The revised statement identifies the unresolved component.

4. Check the language

1. Server: Does removing cheese settle the sauce question?

Cook: No, the sauce is ___.

A. confirmed free of milk

B. checked and cleared

C. still unverified

D. verified against today's recipe

2. Cook: We are still waiting ___ the current recipe specification.

Lead: I'll get it for you.

A. since

B. during

C. by

D. for

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A modifier is not an allergy clearance

Ticket 17 from the case.

01 • Server: The no-cheese request on seventeen is about a milk allergy, not a taste preference.

02 • Cook: Thanks for the new information. Omitting cheese doesn't answer whether the sauce contains milk ingredients.

03 • Server: I had described the dish as suitable once the cheese was removed. That was too broad.

04 • Cook: Please correct that with the guest. The sauce specification and handling question still need the lead's review.

05 • Server: I'll keep the order pending and explain that we need to check the whole preparation.

06 • Cook: I'll give the lead the ticket number and the guest's exact reported concern about milk.

07 • Server: Should I bring the guest another menu while the lead gathers the relevant information?

08 • Cook: You can offer one, but don't name another dish as suitable without its own check.

09 • Server: Understood. I'll explain the unresolved question and invite the lead to discuss it directly with them.

10 • Cook: That lets the diner choose using actual information, not our assumption.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A recipe version matters

A cook finds two ingredient sheets for the same sauce.

01 • Cook: There are two recipe specifications for the sauce, and their ingredient lists don't match.

02 • Lead cook: Are the documents dated, and can you identify which one the current batch refers to?

03 • Cook: The sheets have different dates, but I can't confirm which was used for this batch.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't answer the server from whichever sheet looks newer. We need the batch's actual information.

05 • Cook: I'll keep the suitability question unresolved and show you the two sheets and batch reference.

06 • Lead cook: Please do. What exactly did the diner ask so we check the right concern?

07 • Cook: They asked whether the sauce contains mustard. The server has not reported an allergy or preference yet.

08 • Lead cook: I'll ask the server to clarify that too, without delaying the ingredient-record check you've raised.

09 • Cook: So the batch's allergen declaration and the guest's exact concern both need checking?

10 • Lead cook: I'll handle the recipe review; please obtain the guest's exact wording.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A vegetarian label needs confirmation

A cook questions a proposed menu description without offering dietary certification.

01 • Server: A guest wants the soup without the meat garnish. Can I describe that as vegetarian?

02 • Cook: Not from that change alone. The base recipe matters, and I haven't checked its stock ingredients.

03 • Server: The garnish is the only meat I can see, which is why I thought it worked.

04 • Cook: Visible ingredients don't describe the whole recipe. Let's get the current specification from the lead.

05 • Server: I'll tell the guest removing the garnish is a request, not confirmation of the soup's composition.

06 • Cook: Good. Did they ask about a dietary preference, or report a specific allergy we should relay?

07 • Server: They stated a vegetarian preference. They didn't mention an allergy, and I won't add that label.

08 • Cook: Please pass on that exact preference while we check whether this recipe meets the request.

09 • Server: I'll leave the soup unconfirmed and discuss other choices only with verified ingredient information.

10 • Cook: That avoids turning an appearance-based guess into a menu claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Checking dietary modifications

Ticket 17 says 'no cheese.' The server then reports that the diner has a milk allergy. The sauce specification has not been checked. The cook must not treat omission of cheese as confirmation that the dish is suitable; the lead can review it with the server.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Server: the milk allergy was reported after the initial no-cheese modifier. Relay that change exactly.

Second round: The guest says another restaurant makes it without cheese. Explain why that doesn't verify this recipe.

Scenario 2 | A product changes midweek

A sauce now uses a new branded ingredient. A previous allergen declaration is available, but the new product's declaration has not been checked.

Role A: Cook: question use of the old declaration.

Role B: Lead: obtain the current product information before answering the server.

Possible opening: Does the older declaration cover this new product?

Success checks

- Identify the product change.
- Avoid assuming equivalence.
- Keep the specific dietary question unresolved pending review.

Add a complication: The products have similar packaging and the same descriptive name.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

Request a named response to an observed equipment problem.

SITUATION

The display on scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps going blank. No cause is known. The cook has stopped using it and needs the lead to arrange review and confirm whether scale A is available. Do not offer repair instructions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

equipment fault - A reported problem with how a kitchen device is functioning.

out of service - A status indicating equipment is not available for use.

dish rack - A frame that holds dishes or utensils during handling in the dish area.

bottleneck - A stage where limited capacity delays other kitchen work.

Useful word combinations

report the observed fault: describe what happened without diagnosing it

request a replacement unit: ask for another suitable piece of equipment

prioritize a dish request: identify which needed tableware should be discussed first

give the location: say exactly where the problem or shortage is

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Describe a fault without diagnosing it

3. Notice the language

An observation supports a report, not a technical diagnosis. Name the device, location, effect, and requested help.

The ___ at ___ is ___.

I observed ___; the cause is unknown.

Could you confirm an available ___?

Compare this wording: The electrics are broken.

Clearer: Scale B's display goes blank; the cause hasn't been established.

The observation is supportable and avoids guessing at a repair.

4. Check the language

1. Lead: What did you observe, without knowing the cause?

Cook: The display ___; I couldn't read the quantity.

A. showed an error code

B. went blank

C. lost its external power supply

D. remained steadily lit

2. Cook: Could you arrange ___ of scale B?

Lead: I'll contact the equipment lead.

A. it reviewed

B. review it

C. reviewing it

D. a review

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A blank display is the observation

The scale problem from the case.

01 • Cook: I'm reporting an equipment fault with scale B at pastry prep: its display keeps going blank.

02 • Lead cook: Do you know the cause, or are you reporting only what the display did?

03 • Cook: Only what I observed. I don't know whether the issue is with power or the scale itself.

04 • Lead cook: I'll mark scale B out of service for review. Can you show me its label?

05 • Cook: Could you also confirm whether scale A is available so this prep can continue?

06 • Lead cook: I'll check its availability. Has the pastry quantity already been verified by another method?

07 • Cook: No, that quantity remains unverified. I haven't reported this part of the prep as complete.

08 • Lead cook: Then keep that status clear. I'll bring you a confirmed equipment option after checking.

09 • Cook: Should I give the next cook the device label and location in the handover?

10 • Lead cook: Yes, identify scale B at pastry prep, with review pending and no repair time confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A specific request for the dish team

A cook requests needed plates during a busy service.

01 • Cook: Could you check the availability of small soup bowls? Our station has four left.

02 • Dish colleague: One dish rack of small bowls is in progress, but I don't have a completion time.

03 • Cook: The bowls are the bottleneck now: six soup orders are pending, and we only have four.

04 • Dish colleague: Are you asking for all the bowls from that rack or just the immediate shortfall?

05 • Cook: The immediate shortfall is two bowls. The lead can decide how to allocate the rest.

06 • Dish colleague: I'll tell the lead that number and update you when the rack is ready.

07 • Cook: Please identify small soup bowls, not the larger pasta bowls stored beside them.

08 • Dish colleague: Understood. Is there a completed rack elsewhere that you've already checked for this size?

09 • Cook: I checked our station shelf only. I haven't checked the other approved storage location.

10 • Dish colleague: I'll confirm that location with the lead so we don't duplicate the same search.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A noisy machine needs a location

A kitchen assistant clarifies an equipment report.

01 • Assistant: There's an unusual noise from the dish area, but I haven't identified which machine is involved.

02 • Supervisor: Are you reporting the sound itself, or did you see a particular machine malfunction?

03 • Assistant: The sound only. I don't want to label the dishwasher faulty without checking with the operator.

04 • Supervisor: Good distinction. I'll speak with the dish lead and determine the appropriate response.

05 • Assistant: Should I tell the kitchen all dish service has stopped because of the noise?

06 • Supervisor: No, we haven't established that. Report the concern and keep any service impact unconfirmed.

07 • Assistant: I'll say the dish lead is reviewing an unusual noise, without naming a failed component.

08 • Supervisor: Please also tell me when you first noticed it so the report has a clear reference.

09 • Assistant: I noticed it just after eight, while collecting clean trays near the entrance.

10 • Supervisor: Thank you. That location and time are useful; a guessed diagnosis wouldn't improve the report.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

The display on scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps going blank. No cause is known. The cook has stopped using it and needs the lead to arrange review and confirm whether scale A is available. Do not offer repair instructions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead: you can arrange review; scale A's availability is not yet confirmed.

Second round: The colleague asks whether the fault will be fixed before service. Keep the completion time unconfirmed.

Scenario 2 | Two similar equipment labels

A colleague reports 'mixer two' unavailable, but prep uses labels M2 and M12. The supervisor knows M12 is under review; M2's status is unchanged.

Role A: Cook: clarify the exact label.

Role B: Supervisor: identify M12 and the review status.

Possible opening: Do you mean M2 or M12?

Success checks

- Obtain the exact label.
- Repeat the affected location and device.
- Avoid declaring both devices unavailable.

Add a complication: The caller says 'the big one,' but both look similar from your station.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Closing and handing over unfinished work

Transfer closing work without making incomplete checks disappear.

SITUATION

At shift change, the garnish count is complete at twelve portions, the waste-log entry for three damaged tarts awaits the lead's review, and the closing shelf check has not been performed. Ask the incoming cook to accept the shelf check without treating the waste review as complete.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

closing checklist - A list of tasks to confirm at the end of a kitchen shift.

waste log - A record of food discarded and the stated reason or quantity.

carryover - Food or work remaining from an earlier period, with any permitted use subject to workplace requirements.

sign-off - A recorded acknowledgment that a specified check or task has been completed or approved.

Useful word combinations

hand over an open task: transfer unfinished work with a named receiver

reconcile the portion count: check that records and counted amounts agree

record the stated reason: use the observed or confirmed explanation

leave a check unsigned: do not claim completion before verification

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Separate done, recorded, and approved

3. Notice the language

A written entry can await review. A task assigned to someone isn't complete until they perform it and report back.

___ is complete; ___ awaits review.

Can you take ___ and confirm ___?

I'll retain responsibility for ___.

Compare this wording: It's all in the log.

Clearer: The waste entry is recorded but not reviewed; the shelf check is still outstanding.

The revised handover states two different unfinished actions.

4. Check the language

1. Incoming cook: Has the lead reviewed the waste entry?

Outgoing cook: It is recorded, but review is ____.

- A. pending
- B. discarded
- C. finished
- D. duplicated

2. Outgoing cook: Will you take the shelf check? It hasn't started yet.

Incoming cook: Yes, ____ when it's complete.

- A. I'll confirm
- B. I confirmed
- C. I had confirmed
- D. I've confirmed

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Recorded is not reviewed

The shift-change case with garnish, waste entry, and shelf check.

01 • Outgoing cook: Twelve garnish portions are counted. Two items on the closing checklist are still open.

02 • Incoming cook: Which items are open, and which one are you asking me to take over?

03 • Outgoing cook: The shelf check hasn't been done. Could you complete that check and report its status?

04 • Incoming cook: Yes, I'll take the shelf check. What is the second unfinished item on your list?

05 • Outgoing cook: The waste log lists three damaged tarts; the lead hasn't reviewed that entry yet.

06 • Incoming cook: Will you keep responsibility for that review, or do you want me to ask the lead?

07 • Outgoing cook: I'll keep the review follow-up. You only need to take the shelf check from this handover.

08 • Incoming cook: Understood. Twelve garnish portions counted; shelf check mine; waste review still yours and pending.

09 • Outgoing cook: Exactly. Please don't interpret the recorded waste entry as a completed sign-off by the lead.

10 • Incoming cook: I'll do the shelf check and let you know when it's finished.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A waste reason is unknown

A cook checks a proposed explanation for discarded food.

01 • Cook: The log says four portions discarded, but the reason column is blank on this entry.

02 • Lead cook: Do you know why they were discarded, or only how many were recorded here?

03 • Cook: Only the quantity. A colleague suggested it was an order cancellation, but hasn't confirmed that.

04 • Lead cook: Then don't add that explanation as fact. Ask the person who handled the discard.

05 • Cook: I'll keep the reason unresolved while requesting clarification, rather than choose the most likely category.

06 • Lead cook: Good. Is the quantity itself supported by a count, or does that also need checking?

07 • Cook: The colleague confirmed counting four portions. They couldn't explain why the decision was made.

08 • Lead cook: So we have a confirmed count and an unconfirmed reason. Keep those two statuses distinct.

09 • Cook: I'll tell the incoming cook exactly that and identify who is following up on the reason.

10 • Lead cook: Please take that follow-up yourself and bring me the answer for the record review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Carryover is not permission

An incoming cook asks what an unfinished stock note establishes.

01 • Incoming cook: The handover mentions carryover sauce. Does that mean it's approved for use in today's service?

02 • Outgoing cook: No. The note identifies remaining stock, but the lead still needs to confirm its status.

03 • Incoming cook: Thank you. I won't read a remaining quantity as permission to use it.

04 • Outgoing cook: Exactly. The relevant records are with the lead, and I haven't made that decision.

05 • Incoming cook: Do you have a confirmed quantity so I can describe what's waiting for review?

06 • Outgoing cook: Two labeled containers are listed. I haven't converted that container count into a portion yield.

07 • Incoming cook: I'll report two containers with review pending, not a guessed number of available portions.

08 • Outgoing cook: That's accurate. The new prep plan depends on the lead's decision and the verified yield.

09 • Incoming cook: I'll ask for both details before treating the carryover as part of my available stock.

10 • Outgoing cook: Please do. I'll remain available to explain the earlier note if the lead needs context.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Closing and handing over unfinished work

At shift change, the garnish count is complete at twelve portions, the waste-log entry for three damaged tarts awaits the lead's review, and the closing shelf check has not been performed. Ask the incoming cook to accept the shelf check without treating the waste review as complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Incoming cook: accept the shelf check and ask who retains the waste-log follow-up.

Second round: The lead is unavailable now. Keep review pending rather than treating silence as sign-off.

Scenario 2 | A checklist mark lacks initials

A closing checklist has a tick beside the storage check, but no name or time. Neither cook knows who completed it. The lead can clarify or arrange a new check.

Role A: Outgoing cook: report the ambiguous mark.

Role B: Incoming cook: ask who will verify completion.

Possible opening: Does this tick show a completed check we can actually confirm?

Success checks

- Avoid inferring completion from handwriting.
- Keep status unverified.
- Assign the verification question to the lead.

Add a complication: A colleague says the tick looks like yesterday's handwriting.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Clarifying a prep list

Editing example: Do you mean twenty-four portions from the current recipe?

The question attaches a unit and recipe to the number.

Check 1: C - portions

A: Containers hold food but don't necessarily equal individual servings.

B: Kilograms measure weight, not a number of individual servings.

C: Correct. Portions count the individual servings the lead specified.

D: Batches are production groups that may contain many servings.

Check 2: C - which recipe

A: 'Does' is unnecessary before the verb 'applies'.

B: This reverses the subject phrase.

C: Correct. The noun phrase is the subject of 'applies'.

D: The question word must precede the noun here.

Model response: The soup line says twenty-four, but it doesn't specify portions or containers. Before I start a batch, could you confirm the unit and the recipe version? Yesterday's sheet used portions, while the storage label counts containers. I'll repeat the required yield once we know which quantity today's prep list means.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Reporting deliveries and stock discrepancies

Editing example: Four cases are here; the location of the other two is unconfirmed.

This reports the discrepancy without inventing a cause.

Check 1: D - unconfirmed

A: No one has confirmed those cases at this doorway.

B: The first trolley contains only the four observed cases.

C: No storeroom check has been reported in the exchange.

D: Correct. The driver offers a possibility, not a verified location.

Check 2: D - counted

A: A forecast predicts rather than observes.

B: Ordering states a request to the supplier.

C: Requesting does not establish receipt.

D: Correct. This reports an observation.

Model response: I can count four tomato cases here, while the delivery note lists six. Two may be on the other trolley, but that hasn't been checked. Please keep the received quantity unconfirmed until the receiving lead reconciles the count. I'll show them the four cases and the delivery note together.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Reading tickets and modifications

Editing example: Three total on revised ticket forty-one, not three additional tarts.

The distinction prevents duplicate production.

Check 1: B - total

A: Each doesn't identify the ticket total.

B: Correct. Three is the complete revised quantity.

C: Extra would mean additional items.

D: More would add to the old count.

Check 2: D - instead of

A: This would add a second accompaniment.

B: This keeps both accompaniments rather than replacing the potatoes.

C: This adds salad while retaining potatoes.

D: Correct. 'Instead of' marks replacement of the potatoes.

Model response: Does the revised ticket replace the two-tart quantity on ticket forty-one, or add three more? If it replaces it, I have three tarts total, with salad instead of potatoes on one. Please confirm that modification applies to only one tart so I don't change all three plates.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Coordinating the pass

Editing example: Two of four mains are plated; the remaining pair needs about four minutes.

The update shows what prevents a full pickup.

Check 1: C - still pending

A: The two unfinished dishes haven't been served yet.

B: Finished conflicts with the case.

C: Correct. This identifies incomplete work.

D: Collection would mean they had left the pass.

Check 2: D - approximate

A: The noun doesn't fit this adjective position.

B: An adverb cannot modify 'wait' directly here.

C: This adverb belongs before a quantity, not before this noun alone.

D: Correct. The adjective modifies 'wait'.

Model response: Ticket twenty-eight is not complete yet. Two mains are plated, and the other two are still at my station. My current estimate for that pair is four more minutes. Please don't call the full pickup yet. I'll update you when the remaining dishes are ready for your check at the pass.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Communicating a shortage and an alternative

Editing example: Rice is available for two sides if those diners agree.

The choice stays with the diner instead of being silently imposed.

Check 1: C - an available alternative

A: The original side request was potatoes, not rice.

B: Acceptance hasn't yet been obtained from those diners.

C: Correct. Rice can be offered but isn't yet chosen.

D: The proposed change has not been completed or accepted.

Check 2: D - agree

A: A plural subject needs 'agree', not singular 'agrees'.

B: This participle needs an auxiliary to form the clause.

C: 'Has' doesn't agree with the plural subject 'both guests'.

D: Correct. The plural subject takes 'agree' in this condition.

Model response: We have three unallocated potato portions for this five-meal ticket. Rice is available as an alternative for two meals, but the guests haven't agreed to that change. Could you ask which two diners, if any, would accept rice? I'll keep the original request clear until you bring back their choices.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Checking dietary modifications

Editing example: The cheese omission doesn't answer the milk-allergy question about the sauce.

The revised statement identifies the unresolved component.

Check 1: C - still unverified

A: The case gives no confirmed ingredient finding for the sauce.

B: No completed suitability check has been reported here.

C: Correct. The relevant sauce information remains unchecked.

D: The current recipe hasn't yet been checked for this concern.

Check 2: D - for

A: 'Since' introduces a starting point, not the awaited document.

B: 'During' introduces a period, not what someone awaits.

C: 'By' doesn't connect 'waiting' to its awaited object here.

D: Correct. 'Wait for' introduces the thing being awaited.

Model response: Removing the cheese answers the original modifier, but it doesn't establish that the dish meets this guest's milk-allergy concern. We haven't checked the current sauce specification or the handling question. Please keep ticket seventeen pending while the kitchen lead reviews those details and the server explains what remains unconfirmed to the diner.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Reporting equipment and dish-station needs

Editing example: Scale B's display goes blank; the cause hasn't been established.

The observation is supportable and avoids guessing at a repair.

Check 1: B - went blank

A: No error code was observed or reported in this case.

B: Correct. This describes the visible change without diagnosing its cause.

C: Loss of the external supply is a possible cause, not an established observation.

D: A steadily lit display does not describe the reported disappearance.

Check 2: D - a review

A: This construction would need different wording, such as 'have it reviewed'.

B: The bare verb doesn't fit this noun-phrase position.

C: This duplicates the object before 'of scale B'.

D: Correct. The noun phrase fits before 'of scale B'.

Model response: Scale B at the pastry prep bench keeps losing its display. I've stopped using it, and I don't know the cause. Could you arrange a review and confirm whether scale A is available for this assignment? The pastry prep quantity remains unverified, so I need a confirmed alternative before reporting that task complete.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Closing and handing over unfinished work

Editing example: The waste entry is recorded but not reviewed; the shelf check is still outstanding.

The revised handover states two different unfinished actions.

Check 1: A - pending

A: Correct. Pending means awaiting action.

B: The food was discarded; the review wasn't.

C: The case says review hasn't happened.

D: No duplicate review is reported.

Check 2: A - I'll confirm

A: Correct. Future language commits to reporting after the unfinished check.

B: Past tense would describe confirmation that already happened.

C: Past perfect places confirmation before another past event.

D: Present perfect claims a confirmation has already happened.

Model response: The garnish count is complete: twelve portions. The entry for three damaged tarts is in the waste log, but the lead hasn't reviewed it yet. The closing shelf check hasn't been done. Can you take that check and confirm when it's complete? I'll follow up with the lead about the separate waste-log review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Cooks

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/food-preparation-and-serving/cooks.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Cooks, Restaurant

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/35-2014.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Cooks and Kitchen Staff English

Professional audience: Line cooks, prep cooks, kitchen assistants, and dish-team colleagues

Scope: All situations, quantities, recipes, times, and product details are fictional English practice, not culinary certification or food-safety instruction. This course does not teach cooking temperatures, chemical use, equipment repair, or allergen-control procedures. Follow workplace training and the responsible kitchen lead's decisions. It concerns kitchen communication rather than hospitality management.

Lesson 01: Clarifying a prep list

Original fictional case: The prep list says 'soup: 24' without a unit. Yesterday's sheet used portions; the storeroom label uses containers. The lead intended 24 portions from the current recipe, not 24 containers. No batch has started.

Language workshop: Ask what the number counts

Communication goal: Clarify quantities before interpreting a kitchen shorthand.

Language guidance: Numbers need units. A recipe's yield and a container count describe different things; familiarity with yesterday's sheet isn't confirmation for today.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Does ___ mean portions or ___? / Which recipe version applies to ___? / So the required yield is ___, not ___.

Vocabulary: mise en place: Ingredients and equipment organized for a kitchen's planned work. / prep list: A list of ingredients or components to prepare before or during service. / yield: The usable amount a recipe or ingredient is expected to produce. / batch: A quantity of food prepared as one planned production unit.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead cook: confirm 24 portions using Monday's recipe; container numbers are storage counts.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The cook finds a second sheet dated Friday. Identify which sheet governs today's task.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The soup line says twenty-four, but it doesn't specify portions or containers. Before I start a batch, could you confirm the unit and the recipe version? Yesterday's sheet used portions, while the storage label counts containers. I'll repeat the required yield once we know which quantity today's prep list means.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT

Choose a clear message

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach guided workplace message choices

1. Use only the supplied reference and create one short, realistic dialogue with professional role labels and exactly one missing word or phrase. Supply four distinct options labelled A-D. Ensure that exactly one option fits both the grammar and the stated facts. Do not request a draft, an essay, or any open-ended writing. Stop and wait for my choice.
2. Use plausible distractors based on word combinations, certainty, timing, responsibility, or register. Avoid obviously absurd options. Do not introduce an unverified diagnosis, approval, deadline, charge, or legal rule. If extra fictional facts are necessary, state them explicitly before asking the question.
3. After I choose, identify the correct option and explain briefly why each of the other three options does not fit this exchange. Quote the relevant case fact or wording. Invite me to read both roles aloud; do not claim to assess pronunciation from a typed response.
4. Offer another four-choice exchange that practices a different expression. Present only one question at a time, wait for my answer, and vary the correct letter. If more than one answer is defensible, acknowledge the ambiguity and replace the question rather than marking a reasonable choice wrong.
5. After four exchanges, recap two useful word combinations and one distinction I should revisit. Ask which supported scenario I want to rehearse next, then stop and wait.

END PROMPT